LOCKED ASSEMBLIES AND APP_OFFLINE FILES

When the site is running on IIS, the application's .dll file is loaded by the host process and is locked. If you use FTP to upload the published content, you will need to stop the process to release the .dll files, so they can be overwritten.

There are a number of ways to accomplish this. If you have access to the web server, you can stop the site's application pool and then restart it when the new files have been uploaded. However, this won't provide the visitor with a particularly good experience. A cleaner alternative is to use an app_offline.htm file. When placed in the root folder of the site (that is, the location returned by the `IWebHostEnvironment.ContentRootPath` property), the presence of a filename app_offline.htm results in the graceful shutdown of your website and any further request to the application being served with the content of the file. Therefore this file is most commonly used to display a message explaining the site is currently undergoing maintenance.

The name of the file is important, although case insensitive. The easiest way of switching this feature on and off is using an FTP client to rename the file to something else when the site should be live (e.g., by adding the letter *l* to the extension) and then altering it back when the site should be offline. Because requests for other files will be ignored, you should not link to local resources such as stylesheets, JavaScript, and images in your app_offline.htm file. You should embed these in the file itself. Images can be embedded as Base64-encoded strings.

Prior to ASP.NET Core, this issue was managed by the framework, which used shadow copying to enable the seamless replacement of application